



In October 2018, JFrog received a funding of US \$ 165 million, pushing the valuation of the company beyond US\$ 1 billion. Investors were obviously backing the company's claims that it will make software development easier and faster, and enable firms to reduce their development costs. To understand the basis of this promise, **Rahul Chopra, editorial director, EFY Group**, spoke to **Fred Simon, co-founder and chief architect, JFrog**, and here's what he discovered...

**Fred Simon**, co-founder and chief architect, JFrog

## A DevOps Startup Becomes a Billion-Dollar, Investor's Darling by Making Software Liquid

**Q. How would you explain JFrog's solutions to a senior business decision maker?**

**A.** It's a fair question, as we have been – and continue to be – a developer-driven company that makes tools and solutions for developers. Originally, we were a team of engineers working on Java and had the task of solving some package management problems during the J2EE (now Java EE) transformation. So, it

was all hyper-technical and hard to explain to non-engineers.

Today, it's a bit easier. As the world moves towards cloud-native applications as the default option and every company is now a *software* company, the benefits of software management and delivery are now mission-critical. We see that as this industry has matured, conversations on software are now at the management level. So, it's now

a very simple proposition — you are getting business demands for faster, smarter and more secure software. And you must “Release software fast, or you die,” as we like to say. Competition is fierce, so if you can provide value to the end user faster and smarter without downtime – what we call ‘liquid software’ — you have a competitive edge. JFrog helps you achieve these goals faster as a DevOps organisation.